Study Task - Lessons

Lesson 1 of 5 : Factors and Multiples

Toolbox

Factors and Multiples

A **fraction** is a way of showing part of something. Imagine cutting a pie into eight equal pieces. Each piece is one-eighth of the entire pie.

Fractions are useful in measuring because they are very accurate. The bottom number of a fraction tells you how many equal parts a thing is divided into. The top number tells exactly how many of those parts you have.

You may recall that decimals can also be used to describe a part of something. In fact, decimals are a kind of fraction; however, decimals always break everything into some power of ten. With regular fractions, you can break something into as many parts as you want.

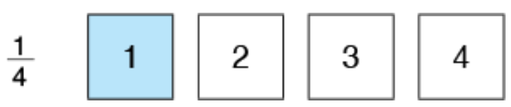
In this lesson, you'll apply fractions in many situations. You will see how to use fractions when working with measurements. You will also see how fractions and decimals are connected.

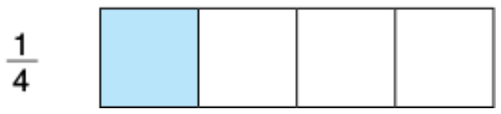
Fractions represent a part of a whole. They can also represent division.

The fraction $\frac{1}{4}$ can mean "1 out of 4 parts."

$\frac{1}{4}$ can also mean "1 divided by 4." The fraction bar in a fraction means "divided by."

"one quarter"





$\frac{1}{4}$ of 4 is 1.

1 divided by 4 is $\frac{1}{4}$ of a whole.

Every fraction has two numbers: a numerator and a denominator. In a **proper fraction**, the numerator is smaller than the denominator.

example: $\frac{3}{4}$ is a proper fraction

$\frac{8}{3}$ is not.

numerator ← top number

denominator ← bottom number

Key Terms

- **fraction**
- **improper fraction**
- **proper fraction**
- **equivalent fractions**
- **mixed number**

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Lesson 4: Fraction Basics

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